

D. Faculty Hiring and Retention – Detailed Processes

1. Process for hiring new faculty.

The process starts with development of a Table of Distribution and Allowances (TDA), which applies to all personnel in the department, including civilian faculty and staff, as well as military faculty members. To increase positions on the TDA, the Department Head must submit a request to the Dean, Office of Personnel and Resources, the G8 resource manager to assure payroll funding exists, The West Point Chief of Staff and the final approval authority is the Army Chief of Staff. It is very difficult to add positions to the TDA as they require a guaranteed source funding to cover payroll salary and benefits which add another 30% to the cost. Changes to the payroll budget for all of West Point are approved by the Department of Defense, included in the President's Budget, and ultimately sent to Congress for final approval. The TDA for the academy and for the department is available for examination on request by the visit team.

The processes for hiring military and civilian faculty and the civilian staff are described below. The local point of contact for questions on any of these processes is Mr Walter Rittger.

Civilian Hiring Process. Once the position is established on the TDA as being both required and authorized, the process for filling a position is as follows:

- A request for recruitment action is forwarded to the Office of the Dean, Plans and Resources Division (PRD). The Vice Dean for Resources. His staff determines that there is a valid vacancy and funding available to recruit for the vacant position.
- Once approved by Dean's PRD, the personnel action is routed electronically to the Superintendent's Resource Manager (known in the military as the G8). The G8 approves or disapproves the recruitment action based on the TDA and the availability of funding for the hire.
- The recruitment action is then forwarded electronically to the Chief of Staff for the Superintendent, who approves or disapproves on behalf of the Superintendent. If approved, the recruitment action is forwarded to the Civilian Personnel Advisory Center (CPAC).
- CPAC contacts the department for a recruitment advertisement based on a department approved position description and places the recruitment advertisement in USA Jobs. (www.usajobs.gov) The advertisement normally stays open for 10 days.
- CPAC personnel review the applications and send a list of best qualified applicants back to the department, along with their resumes or CVs. Candidates will be interviewed, a selection made and a referral list (DA2600) is returned to CPAC. Priority placement is given to qualified spouses of active duty military, to persons who were separated involuntarily due to a reduction in force (RIF), or whose job was abolished due to a managerial realignment or attrition.
- CPAC will present the official notification of selection and the start date of employment. For civilian staff, the initial screening happens at CPAC and is not under our control.
- For civilian faculty, the process differs at this point from that for civilian staff. The difference is that CVs are sent back to the department for a selection committee to screen based on program-level criteria. Interviews are conducted, selections are made, and the outcome presented to the Head of the Department. All candidate files and the selection matrix are forwarded to an HR specialist at the Civilian Personnel Advisory Center. The

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HR specialist will assign extra credits for veterans, military spouses, or Federal employees with a hiring priority. The list of applicants (or CVs) for civilians is screened at the department level by a hiring committee, and the committee makes a recommendation to the Department Head. Once the Department Head concurs, CPAC is notified of the selection. A memo detailing the selection process followed and the chosen candidate is forwarded to the Dean of the Academic Board along with the candidate's transcripts. If the Dean agrees with the selection committee, the memo is then forwarded to the Civilian Personnel Advisory Center and an HR specialist presents an offer to the best candidate. If the candidate accepts the offer, an in-depth background check begins. Upon conclusion of the background check, an entry on duty date is established for the new employee.

- Veterans get preference points depending on when they served in the armed forces and whether or not they were disabled or wounded (no points for retired military).

Rotating Military Faculty. The process is described in detail in DPOM 3-10, "USMA Military Rotating Faculty Selection." This DPOM describes academy-level features of the process. There are some aspects of this process that are specific to our department. The detailed department-specific process, as well as a detailed timeline for the process, is documented in a standard operating procedure (SOP) maintained by our Faculty Recruiting Officer, who does this as an additional duty. A description of the process follows below:

- The process begins with faculty recruitment. Rotating military faculty candidates are directly recruited from the Army by the various departments at the Academy. Our department uses the Total Army Personnel Information Management System to screen for and identify suitable candidates. We also keep records on outstanding cadets and track their careers individually.
- Once identified, the faculty candidates are then encouraged to apply for positions at the Academy. Candidates apply through the Academy's TEACH application website.
- The TEACH system allows candidates to upload GRE scores, an Officer Record Brief (ORB), Officer Evaluation Reports (OERs), the Candidate Statement, transcripts, and Army Fitness Test (AFT) scores.
- Once completed, all applications are carefully reviewed by a department faculty committee.
- The top candidates are forwarded to the Army Human Resources Command (AHRC). AHRC reviews each candidate to determine if the candidate's career timeline and manner of performance merit assignment at USMA.
- The final order of merit list (OML) of AHRC-approved candidates is presented to the Department Head for final approval and selection for assignment to USMA. The West Point G1 (general-staff personnel managers) are notified and keep a record of these officers in the "Blue Book."
- Following selection, the officers attend a 24-month graduate program in an area related to the department's disciplines and teaching needs. Second-tour rotating faculty and Academy Professors attend a doctoral program for up to 36-months.

Academy Professors. The process is described in detail in DPOM 3-20, "Procedures for Selecting Academy Professors." The DPOM describes all of the features of the process, but some of these items are out of date, and the current process is described below.

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- The process is initiated by the Department Head, who sends a request to the Personnel Resources Division of the Office of the Dean (PRD) to verify that the position exists in the TDA, that it is funded, and to authorize a search. The Department Head sends a proposed advertisement, recommendation for a search committee, and parameters to query the Army for qualified candidates.
- The PRD notifies the G1 of the requirement to establish the search and advertises the search on the G1 web site.
- The PRD also prepares a staff summary sheet to obtain the Dean's and Superintendent's approval for the search, to describe the composition of the search committee, and includes the advertisements.
- The Dean and Superintendent must approve the search and committee membership.
- The PRD publishes the committee orders and distributes them to the committee members.
- The AHRC notifies all eligible Army officers (Captains through Colonels) by email of the vacancy, with instructions on how to contact the committee secretary if they wish to apply.
- The committee secretary collects applications, and the committee reviews the applications to determine which candidates should be interviewed.
- After the interviews are completed, the committee provides the names of the finalists to the PRD for assessment of availability and sustainability by the AHRC.
- The committee meets with the Dean of the Academic Board to brief him or her on their selection and the process involved.
- If the Dean approves the selection and feels that the selection committee has made every effort to seek diversified, qualified, candidates, the Dean and the selection committee then brief the Superintendent on the selection. If the Superintendent agrees that the committee has performed the search to the best of their abilities and approves of their selection, the candidate(s) are then added to the Academic Board agenda for a vote to approve the candidate. If the Academic Board approves the candidate(s), the candidate is then notified of their selection. Non-selectees are also notified at that time by the Chair of the selection committee.
- PRD prepares the official nomination for the selected officer and forwards the nomination through the USMA G1 for the Army G1, who then coordinates the nomination with the AHRC and publishes orders for assignment to USMA as an Academy Professor.

Professors USMA. The process is described in detail in DPOM 3-19, "Procedures for Selecting Academy Professors." The DPOM describes all of the features of the process, but some of these items are out of date, and the current process is described below.

- The process is initiated by the Department Head, sends a request to the Personnel Resources Division of the Office of the Dean (PRD) to verify that the position exists in the TDA, that it is funded, and to authorize a search. The Department Head sends a proposed advertisement, recommendation for a search committee, and parameters to query the Army for qualified candidates.

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- The PRD notifies the G1 of the requirement to search and advertises the search on the G1 web site.
- The PRD submits a request for Department of the Army representation to the G1.
- The PRD also prepares a staff summary sheet to obtain the Dean's and Superintendent's approval for the search, to describe the composition of the search committee, and includes the advertisements.
- The Dean and Superintendent must approve the search and committee membership.
- The PRD publishes the committee orders and distributes them to the committee members.
- The AHRC notifies all eligible Army officers (Captains through Colonels) by email of the vacancy, with instructions on how to contact the committee secretary if they wish to apply.
- The committee secretary collects applications, and the committee reviews the applications to determine which candidates should be interviewed.
- The committee determines that most qualified candidates to be interviewed. The number of in-person interviews is based on budget availability. Video Teleconference (VTC) interviews are encouraged.
- After the interviews are completed, the committee provides the names of the finalists to the PRD for assessment of availability and sustainability by the AHRC.
- The committee makes a recommendation to the Dean. If the Dean approves the selection, the Dean and the committee present their recommendation to the Superintendent. If the Superintendent agrees with the selection, the selection is presented to Academic Board for approval. Upon Academic Board approval, the selectee is notified. Non-selectees are notified by the committee Chair.
- PRD prepares the official nomination for the selected officer and forwards the nomination through the USMA G1 for the Army G1.
- The Army G1 coordinates the nomination as appropriate to obtain a recommendation from the President of the United States and confirmation by the United States Senate.
- The nominated officer is notified of the Senate confirmation and AHRC and publishes orders for assignment to USMA.
- The nominated officer coordinates with the USMA G1 for an official ceremony.